ACTIVITY 5

Visit ready mix plant nearby and prepare a report.

In case of where it is difficult to lift the concrete to large heights by employing manual labour, concrete is pumped up through specially designed pumps. These `pump concrete mix should be designed in such a way that they do not allow segregation.

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The ready mix concrete while being transported in rotating drums which keep the concrete in agitated condition as well a dose of retarding agents (additives) are added to the concrete.

4.3.6 Compaction of Concrete



The thoroughly mixed concrete should be placed continuously and compacted rapidly. The main aim of compaction is to remove air bubbles and thus give a maximum density to concrete. Compaction can be done in 2 ways.

1. Hand Compaction
2. Mechanical Compaction

4.3.6.1 Hand Compaction



This is done with the help of steel tamping rods or timber screeds. Narrow and deep members are compacted with tamping rods. The slabs and floors are tamped with screeds. Compaction should be done in layers of 300mm for mass concrete and 150 mm for reinforced concrete.

4.3.6.2 Mechanical Compaction





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